

1946, October 25th

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

October 25th 1946

Mr. Joseph J. O'Donnell
1120 Lake Shore Drive
Chicago

St. Felix Friary
Route 8
Huntington, Indiana

Mr. and Mrs. - Joe and Win O'Donnell

Yes, just starting my 77th anniversary as your wrie held me up at my above,
first period after the date, - just starting to answer your charitable
letter received this am. Many thanks for your generosity as well as for
so kind a remembrance on this ocasion.

I had some friends down from Detroit yesterday to remind me of and to
congratulate on my 76thB-day.

I was on retreat last week and on Sunday went to Detroit and in the evening
to Windsor, Ontario, Can. to the "Send-off celebration" given to Fr.
Julius O.F.M.Cap. by his old friends in the parish of his childhood -
Our Lady of Prompt Succor. He was supposed to leave for Guam Missions in
November. It was Monday evening when we returned and I felt I must get
at my work and catch up, etc. Well, Deo gratia for every thing! Thanks
be to Go.

As to your German candidate farm-manager's system of religion - lutheran:
well, it might be better and would certainly be more promising if he were
known to be a practical Catholic; but if he give evidence of honesty and
the fear of God and thrift as best he can - with experience bhind him, I
would be ~~rather~~ inclined to him rather than to a fresh graduate from most/
of our universities who have had little or no practical farm experien.

After all the lutherans, as a rule, know more of Christianity than most
any of the other non-catholic Christian denominations. Besides, these day
protestantism as a whole seems to be rapidly crumbling. The whole trouble
with honest protestants - and thank God there a lot or such - is that thy
simply do not know the real relationship between their own denomination and
the Mother-church. Otherwise equal, I would take a conscientious lutheran
ten times in preference to just a nominal Catholic. I know from childhood
how to appreciate German lutherans. If the change of clamate benot too
radical and this man's wife and daughter can aide, etc, I would be inclined
in his favor.

In the mean time, however, let us pray for dïvine grudance - especially
turning to St. Josep and the Poor Souls. How about inviting the latter to
- especially our own relatives amongst them - to take an interest with us
and become missionaries with a promise to enroll them, e.g., for a certain
% of the proffits. That I always call a double charity; to our neighbor,
viz, to our fellow members of the militent Church, the missionaries and
their work and then to the Church-suffering, the poor, holy souls.